Roast Room: what Safr builds next

1 November 2026 · Seats: Graham, Hormozi, Bezos, Buffett, Elon, Gary V · Rounds: 3 · Mode: full

Verdict: GO

The call: Choose D. Build nothing new yet. Take the current preview into UAE agencies, run real family files through it at their counter, and let what they ask for decide whether A (login) or B (submission pack) comes next. C waits until three agencies pay.

Option scores: A 4.4 · B 4.5 · C 1.5 · D 9.0 · Support for the resolution 8.2/10 · Confidence 8/10 · Spread 0 · Vote: 1 endorse, 5 amend, 0 dissent

Round 1 was unanimous for D, so the unanimity check applied: Round 2 made Hormozi and Graham argue your lean (B) at full strength, and Bezos defend a 5-day version of B. D held.

Scorecard

Seat	Weight	Final stance	A	B	C	D	Pillar score	Moved?	Their line
Graham (product)	3	Endorse, amend	4	4	1	9	8	Added a payment deadline	"Find the one agency that would be bummed if Safr went away, and do whatever it takes by hand to make them love it."
Hormozi (offers)	3	Endorse, amend	5	4	1	9	8	Prepay first to one free file first	"Compliments ain't cash."
Bezos (strategy)	2	Endorse	5	5	2	9	9	Dropped thin B for a hand-made pack	"Storing passport data is your only one-way door, so let paying customers open it and keep every other call fast."
Buffett (money)	2	Endorse, amend	4	5	2	9	8	B 5 to 6 to 5	"Hold out for the first invoice, and store no passport anywhere until someone is paying."
Elon (speed)	2	Endorse, amend	4	5	2	9	8	Price ask at file 10	"The constraint is zero real files, not missing features."
Gary V (attention)	1	Endorse, amend	4	5	2	9	8	B 6 to 5	"The counter day is your content."

Math (weights 3, 3, 2, 2, 2, 1; total 13):
A (3x4 + 3x5 + 2x5 + 2x4 + 2x4 + 1x4) / 13 = 4.4
B (3x4 + 3x4 + 2x5 + 2x5 + 2x5 + 1x5) / 13 = 4.5
C (3x1 + 3x1 + 2x2 + 2x2 + 2x2 + 1x2) / 13 = 1.5
D (3x9 + 3x9 + 2x9 + 2x9 + 2x9 + 1x9) / 13 = 9.0
Support (3x8 + 3x8 + 2x9 + 2x8 + 2x8 + 1x8) / 13 = 8.2

Why the council landed here

- With no users, every build is a guess. The fastest way to learn which build matters is to watch agents use the preview on real files. (Graham, make something people want, S098)
- The limit is zero real files, not missing features. The metric is real applications per week through Safr, and today it is zero. (Elon, find the limiting factor, S002)

- Storing passport and Emirates ID data is the one decision that is hard to undo. Today Safr stores nothing, and that is an asset. Keep it until paying customers justify the risk. (Bezos, Type 1 and Type 2 decisions, S063; Buffett, ruin and the newspaper test, S028)
- Compliments are not demand. Ask for money early, and the buyer will tell you what to build. (Hormozi, constraint first, S113)
- B fails on cost, not merit. The builder can zip the existing PDFs and cover sheets by hand during the demo and on camera. That tests the same thing as five days of code, for free. (Graham, Hormozi, Gary V, Elon; Bezos and Buffett moved to it in Round 3)

Where they fought

Can a real pilot run on the no-login preview? Hormozi opened with login first, paid for by the pilot. Elon answered that nothing is stored and the records sit on the agency's own PC, where its spreadsheets already are. Buffett showed $2,700 of pilot money cannot pay for $16,000 of build. Resolved: start on the preview, with a trigger to build a login-only A (no stored scans).

Charge up front or free usage first? Hormozi and Buffett wanted cash first. Graham and Elon wanted real files first. In Round 2 everyone met in the middle: free use first, then ask for money at the 10th file or by day 14. Hormozi reopened this in Round 3 and lost (see the minority report).

Is a five-day B worth building as a demo closer? Bezos and Buffett said yes, at a cap of 5 days. Graham, Hormozi, Gary V, and Elon said assemble the pack by hand until agencies ask. Nobody rebutted the hand-made pack, and by Round 3 Bezos and Buffett had both dropped the build.

Minority report

Hormozi wanted the price asked the same day as the first real file: "Make the price ask the same day as the first real file: $900 prepaid for 3 months, and the two weeks become a money-back window, not a free trial." For him to be right, agencies must be willing to prepay after one watched file. If the first three agencies prepay on the spot, he was right, and every later pitch should open with the prepay ask.

Conditions

1. No passport scans or passport data on a Safr server until 3 agencies pay at least AED 1,000 a month and a data processing agreement is in place.
2. Each pilot agency signs a one-page data-handling note before its first real file. It says the builder clears preview records from the browser after every session and no scans are saved to the shared PC.
3. Login trigger: if 2 of the first 5 agencies refuse a real file without accounts by 15 Nov, or 3 of the first 10 by 22 Nov, and they would pay once accounts exist, build the cut-down A: login and agency isolation, no stored scans, in 2 weeks.
4. The pack is assembled by hand. Build B (5 working days, no new rules) only when 3 of 10 agencies ask for it unprompted, or the timed files show the VFS/TLS/BLS handoff is the main time cost.
5. Free use for at most two weeks per agency, then the price ask at the 10th real file or on day 14, whichever comes first.

What to do next

1. **By 8 Nov:** the BD partner books 10 in-person demos from a list of 50 named agencies. The builder spends one day at one agency counter timing 5 real family files by hand against Safr, films the first one ending on the hand-zipped pack, and posts it on LinkedIn. The builder also writes the data-handling page.
2. **By 22 Nov:** 20 pitches made, 10 real files through Safr, the login trigger decided, one file taken all the way to a VFS submission. From then on, count each week the agencies using Safr with the builder out of the room.
3. **By 15 Dec:** at least 3 paid pilots (assumed $900 for 3 months), with the first paid commitment by 1 Dec.

Cheapest test: one day at one agency counter, timing 5 real family files by hand against Safr. That day tells you the minutes saved, whether agencies will use it without a login, and where the pain is.
Kill criteria: by 15 Dec, 10 or more real files each saved at least 30 minutes and no agency pays, or zero agencies use Safr without the builder present. Either way, stop and rethink the price and the buyer (try corporate travel desks) before building anything.
Revisit: bring this back to the council on 15 Dec with real numbers: minutes per family file by hand and with Safr, files per agency per month, refusals over login, and agencies paying.

Simulated advisors built from each person's public work. They are not the people and do not speak for them.